

PGDM/PGDM (BM) 2025-2027		SPJIMR- Course outline	
Course Name	Financial Innovation & Fintech	Credits	2
Course Code	FIN521-PDM-46	Term	IV
Instructor(s)	Prof. Vidhu Shekhar		
Lead Instructor	Prof. Vidhu Shekhar	TA/RA	Nidhi Maniar / Shraddha Joshi
No. of Sessions	18	No. of Group Work sessions	

Course Description:

Innovation is innate to humans. As they say, necessity is the mother of invention. Like in other fields the area of Finance has witnessed innovations all along. There has been innovation in terms of financial products, markets, technologies, regulations and philosophies. How did some of these innovations take shape? What need was served and how did the solutions shape up. These are the questions that we will address in this course.

The magnitude and pace of innovation has significantly picked up in the last few years, with the introduction of Fintech. Technology is playing an increasingly dominant role in the financial services industry, empowering existing players and threatening to obliterate business models of entire sectors within the industry.

The implications of Fintech related innovations are even larger for emerging countries like India, which can directly leapfrog to be a leader in the industry without going through the rigmarole of inventing the technology required.

A significant portion of this course exposes students to this fast-growing and exciting intersection between technology and finance – P2P lending, Loan processing, Block chains, Crypto currency, Bitcoins, electronic payments, financial applications of machine learning, robo-advising, fintech ventures and other topics.

Course Learning Outcomes:

By the end of this course, students should be/will be able to:

CLO 1. Have a multi-dimensional appreciation of FinTech and the manner in which it is disrupting traditional Finance.

CLO 2. Be introduced to leading technologies such as Blockchain, Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning, Bitcoin/Cryptocurrency Ecosystem and their application in FinTech.

CLO 3. Be able to undertake innovation in the space.

Prescribed Text:

1. Blockchain for Business Application: From Cryptographic Principles to Business Integration, by Shekhar & Baag.

Additional Readings:

FinTech for Managers: A Handbook, by Shekhar, Baag, Kumar, Jha. – Suggested reading

Pedagogy:

The classes will be a mix of lectures, discussions, and case study applications. Students are advised to be well prepared before every class with pre-assigned readings including case studies and/or mini cases.

Course Evaluation:

S. No.	Evaluation Component (Individual/ Group)	Evaluation Code	Weightage	Timeline for announcing evaluation	Scheduled Date of Evaluation	CLOs Mapped to Evaluations
1.	Case submission	FIN521-PDM-46-I01	20%	In Session 1	After class 18	1, 2
2.	Group Project	FIN521-PDM-46-G01	40%	In Session 1	Class 17, 18	1, 2, 3
3.	End Term exam	FIN521-PDM-46-I02	40%	In Session 1	After class 18	1, 2, 3
	Total		100%			

Note: A surprise quiz can be conducted by the faculty at any point of time during the course. The weightage of the evaluation components will be adjusted accordingly.

Student Honour Code

1. All students are expected to read the assigned readings before class. The course handout will include lessons, cases prescribed for sessions, and the class schedule, in addition to the prescribed readings.
2. Every student is expected to follow the 'honesty' policy in academic affairs and do their academic work. Any form of cheating or plagiarism constitutes unacceptable academic dishonesty. Please refer to SPJIMR's plagiarism policy.
3. Appropriate classroom behaviour is required for effective learning. These behaviours include timely arrival, attentiveness during class, and only authorized use of devices (per the faculty members' prerogative).
4. SPJIMR is committed to continuously advancing its academic excellence. It is, therefore, mandatory for the student to provide feedback whenever the program requests it. Please note that all student feedback is anonymous.

Group Project details:

The group project is an opportunity to apply the knowledge and tools covered in the course to an original business idea developed by your group.

The project can be presented as a slide deck or as a word document. In any case, make sure to include all the explanations in the presentation such that the document is self-explanatory.

Your group project outlining your Fintech venture idea should cover the following points:

- 1) Venture goal
- 2) Problem your venture is solving
- 3) Solution you are building
- 4) Market size
- 5) Technology and product
- 6) Competition
- 7) Business model (How do you plan on making money)
- 8) Justification for VC investment in the venture
- 9) Customer acquisition
- 10) Role of regulation

Your final group project grade is determined based on the following criteria:

- a) 25% - innovativeness of the venture
- b) 25% - analysis of the industry and the strategy of existing and potential competitors
- c) 25% - defensibility of the business model
- d) 25% - integration of data and analytics into the model

Session Details:

Session No & Faculty	Session Plan	Pedagogy	Suggested/Prescribed Readings	Mandatory Sessions
1, 2	Course Introduction • Money and Finance • The history of money • The types of money • Innovating Finance & Economy with money	Lecture		Yes
3, 4	Financial Innovation History • Products, Markets Financial and Tech, i.e. FinTech, Innovation • Introduction	Lecture		Yes

	• Landscape • Blockchain and AI/ML in Finance			
5,6	Blockchain as a Tech innovation & Cryptographic Gamification • Blockchain Introduction • Cryptography, Hashing • The Blockchain Gamification & Flow chart • Types of Blockchain and Smart contracts	Lecture and Cases	Ripple 2023: 724372-PDF-ENG Deutsche Bank: Pursuing Blockchain Opportunities (A) 817100-PDF-ENG	
7,8	Money and Cryptocurrency Innovations • Bitcoin, and 20000 other Cryptocurrencies • ICOs & NFTs • CBDCs, DeFi • FTX, Madoff, Chit Funds & Ponzi schemes • The Geopolitics of Payment systems	Lecture		
9, 10, 11	Innovations, Payments & Alternative lending • Swift UPI and Payment Systems • Paytm v/s Bharat Pay • P2P Lending: Lending Club v/s Credit Ease • Lend Tech	Lecture and cases	Case: National Payments Corporation of India: Cutting-Edge Fintech Ecosystem Innovation in India W21211-PDF-ENG Case: Credit Ease: Taking inclusive Finance online – HBS case no. 9-316-151 Case: Lending Club E597-PDF-ENG	
12, 13,14	Innovations in Wealth Tech and Insure Tech • Impact of Fintech on Wealth Management	Lecture and Cases	Zerodha in 2023: A Pioneer Battles Challengers in the Post-Pandemic Era W34161-PDF-ENG	

	• Robo Advisory & Virtual Financial Advisors • AltPMS & Digital Age Clients • Tech in Insurance, IOT • Tech Distribution & Scaling of Financial Products		Privé Technologies: Digitalization of Asset Management Services in Hong Kong ST99-PDF-ENG Razorpay Software Pvt Ltd: Expanding into new territories with Razor-sharp tech focus A00399-PDF-ENG Coverfox.com: From Troubling Times to Turnaround? W31497-PDF-ENG	
15,16	Regulations & Other Manifestation of Fintech • AI/ML in Finance • AlgoTradings • Blockchain's varied Manifestations • The Evolving Regulations in FinTech	Lecture and Cases	Paytm: A Payments Journey in India 824039-PDF-ENG Minko: Developing a Niche Fintech Lending Business Model W34546-PDF-ENG Case: Quants in Utopia? Quantopian and its Crowd Wisdom Hedge-Fund Model – HBS case no. HK 1109	
17, 18	Group Project Presentation			

AOL Alignment of the Course:

Alignment of intended Program Competency Goals & Course Learning outcomes:

Competency Goals (CGs)	Programme Learning Objectives (PLOs) (with Blooms Taxonomy)	TLAs code (CLO)	Assessment code	Course learning outcomes	Asmt. method & weightage
CG 1: Responsible and socially sensitive leaders	PLO 1.1 Demonstrate social sensitivity.				
	PLO1.2 Recommend responsible solutions to management problems.				
	PLO1.3 Demonstrate self-awareness and self-development.				
CG 2: Capable of managing in a global environment	PLO 2.1 Interpret key aspects of the Indian and global business environment.				
	PLO 2.2 Analyse the Indian and global business environment for decision making.				
CG 3: Proficient in functional and cross-functional business areas	(PGDM) PLO 3.1 Demonstrate depth in selected functional areas of business.	✓✓✓	XXX	CLO 1	Case Submission Group Work End Term
	(PGDM-BM) PLO 3.1 Demonstrate breadth across functional areas of business.				
	PLO 3.2 Integrate across functional areas for decision-making.	✓✓	XX	CLO 2	Case Submission Group work
CG 4: Able to make reasoned decisions	PLO 4.1 Examine business problems and alternative solutions.				
	PLO 4.2 Recommend reasoned and actionable solutions.				
	PLO 4.3 Demonstrate clarity in thinking and articulation.				
CG 5: Innovative leadership	PLO 5.1 Understand principles and practices for innovation.	✓✓✓	XX	CLO 3	Group work & End Term
	PLO 5.2 Develop innovative solutions in various managerial contexts.	✓✓	XX	CLO 3	Group work & End Term

***Please only tick the most relevant CGs and PLOs**

Codes for AOL Table

Codes for Teaching Learning Activities (TLA)			
Objective not covered	Objective barely covered (concept introduced)	Objective is addressed (concept practiced) but needs further development	Very strong-TLAs designed to promote thorough, deep and active learning
-	✓	✓✓	✓✓✓
Code for Assessment (Asmt.)			
Objective not covered	Objective barely covered	Objective is addressed but would need further development to demonstrate learning	Very strong - thorough, deep assessment of objective that would clearly demonstrate learning
-	X	XX	XXX

SDGs mapped to the course (Descriptions appended)

S.No.	UN SDG Goals	UN SGD Target	Please Tick the applicable
1	Goal 4: Quality Education	4.7	✓
2	Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth	8.2, 8.3	
3	Goal 9: Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure	9.1, 9.4, 9 b	✓
4	Goal 10: Reduced Inequalities	10.2, 10.3	
5	Goal 12: Responsible Consumption and Production	12.6	
6	Goal 16: Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions	16.6, 16.7	
7	Goal 17: Partnerships to achieve the Goals	17.16, 17.17	

Sessions/Cases/Discussion centered around ERS		
Content	Session No.	Any case/reading used
Ethics	12, 13, 14, 15	Discussions
Responsibility		NA
Sustainability		NA

Faculty Contact Preference

Office Hours -

Email - ☒

Call/WhatsApp -